INTERNSHIP REPORT

Submitted

For the Partial Fulfilment of the Requirement for the Degree of Bachelor of _____ with _____ (Major and Minor Subjects) under **Magadh University**

Submitted to

The Department of _____, _____ **(College Name)**

[Paste College Logo here]

Submitted by

Name : _____

Semester : _____

Programme FYUGP : _____

University's Registration No. : _____

College Roll No. : _____

Year : _____

RK NEXORA
CAMPUS TO CAREER
A Unit of RKNexora Private Limited.

INTERNSHIP REPORT

Topic - Agri-Business Management

Submitted to the Head of Department, _____ (College Name), in partial fulfilment of the requirements for the Degree of _____, Magadh University

Name of Student : _____

Programme : _____

University Registration No. : _____

College Roll No. : _____

Internship Registration No. : _____

Name of the IPO / Agency : RKNEXORA PRIVATE LIMITED

Internship Period : _____ to _____

Semester : _____

Year / Session : _____

RKNEXORA PRIVATE LIMITED
RKNEXORA
PRIVATE LIMITED
GAYA, BIHAR - 805236, INDIA

_____ _____

Signature of Student **Seal & Signature of IPO**

ACKNOWLEDGEMENT

I express my sincere gratitude to RK NEXORA, RKNEXORA PRIVATE LIMITED, _____ (College Name), my faculty mentors and the internship supervisor, _____, for their guidance and support. The structured activities, learning resources and regular feedback helped me complete this internship in Agri-Business Management successfully.

I am thankful to the Head of the Department and the college mentor for their encouragement and for guiding me in preparing this report. I am also grateful to the management of RKNEXORA PRIVATE LIMITED for providing a professional learning environment and the opportunity to learn and apply my knowledge in a practical setting. The concept sessions, hands-on tasks with sample farm records and forms, and the supervisor's patient and detailed feedback helped me understand how the agri-business system works behind the scenes.

Finally, I thank my family and peers for their constant encouragement throughout the programme.

_____

Name: _____

University Registration No. - _____

INTERNSHIP COMPLETION CERTIFICATE

The Internship Completion Certificate issued by RKNEXORA PRIVATE LIMITED for the internship in Agri-Business Management is to be attached on this page.

[Attach the original / printed copy of the QR-verified Internship Completion Certificate here]

Certificate No. _____

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PREFACE

Internships are an important part of the undergraduate programme, as they allow students to see how classroom learning is applied in real organisations. The Four-Year Undergraduate Programme (FYUGP), introduced in line with the National Education Policy 2020, gives special importance to experiential learning, skill development and employability. This report has been prepared as part of the internship requirement of Magadh University and the Higher Education guidelines applicable in Bihar.

The report describes the internship undertaken in Agri-Business Management at RKNEXORA PRIVATE LIMITED, the plan followed, the work carried out, and the learning gained. Agriculture is not only farming. It is a whole business system that starts with seed, fertiliser and credit, continues through the farm and the post-harvest handling of produce, and ends in storage, markets, processing and the consumer, supported all along by insurance, finance and government policy. A farm that is managed like a business, with plans, records, costs and benefits, earns more and faces less risk. In Bihar, where most farms are small and many families depend on agriculture, such management skills can make a large difference. This internship offered a first-hand introduction to the management side of agriculture.

The report has been arranged in the order suggested by the University, beginning with the cover page and acknowledgement and ending with the conclusion and attendance sheet. It is hoped that the report gives a clear and honest account of the internship experience. All examples in it use dummy data and fictitious names; no real farmer, bank or company information was handled.

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

This report documents the internship completed in Agri-Business Management at RKNEXORA PRIVATE LIMITED (RK NEXORA - 'Campus to Career'). The programme required a minimum of 120 hours, completed over about four to five weeks (28 working days) with daily sessions of four to five hours, and was supported by an attendance log, supervisor guidance and review.

Background. Agri-business management is the application of management principles - planning, organising, directing and controlling - to the businesses of the agricultural sector. These include the farm itself, the suppliers of seeds, fertilisers and pesticides, post-harvest handling, warehousing, finance and insurance, commodity markets and the policies that govern them. Good agri-business management helps to use land, labour, water and money efficiently, reduce risk and losses, and earn a fair profit. For a student from any discipline, the internship shows how economics, accounting, supply chain, finance and policy work together in the farm sector.

Objectives. The internship aimed to (i) build a structured understanding of the agri-business sector and its value chain, (ii) learn farm management basics and the input supply chain, (iii) learn post-harvest management and warehousing and storage, (iv) understand agri finance and credit, crop insurance and agri commodity markets, (v) study agricultural policy and carry out a simple cost-benefit analysis, and (vi) develop communication, documentation and professional discipline.

Work carried out. The student first studied the agri-business overview and farm management basics, then worked through the input supply chain, post-harvest management, agri finance and credit, crop insurance, warehousing and storage, agri commodity markets, agricultural policy and cost-benefit analysis. Each topic had a concept session followed by a hands-on task using sample records, forms and dummy data. The later part of the programme was devoted to a case study, a mock practical exercise, supervisor review and preparation of this report.

Project. The work was tied together in a project titled *Agri-Business Supply Chain & Cost Analysis*, in which the agri value chain, post-harvest handling and finance options were analysed with a cost-benefit study.

Method. A blended method was followed - learn, practise, document and review - supported by a daily attendance log with day-wise remarks and regular feedback from the supervisor.

Learning gained. The student gained a clear understanding of how the agri value chain works, practical familiarity with crop budgets, input planning, loan interest, insurance premium and claim, storage cost, hedging and cost-benefit calculations in MS Excel, awareness of MSP, KCC, crop insurance, warehouse receipts and commodity exchanges, and improved communication, analysis and professional discipline.

Key observations. A farm that keeps records and knows its cost of cultivation can make better decisions; timely inputs, institutional credit and insurance protect the farmer from heavy losses; storage and warehouse finance give a farmer the power to wait for a better price; and every investment should be checked with a cost-benefit analysis before money is committed.

Conclusion. The internship met its objectives and contributed to the student's academic understanding, employability and confidence. The report follows the University's suggestive format: cover page, acknowledgement, certificate, contents, preface, executive summary, about the agency, plan and execution, learning outcome, conclusion and attendance sheet.

ABOUT THE AGENCY

RK NEXORA, a unit of RKNEXORA PRIVATE LIMITED, provides structured internship and skill-development programmes under the theme 'Campus to Career'. The organization focuses on academic-industry alignment, practical exposure, assessment, documentation and employability-oriented learning.

Particulars	Details
Name of Agency	RKNEXORA PRIVATE LIMITED
Programme / Unit	RK NEXORA - Campus to Career
Registered Office	C/O Mukesh Kumar, Khiri, PS Atri, Jethiyan, Atri, Gaya - 805236, Bihar, India
CIN	U85499BR2026PTC086757
Email	rknexorapvtltd@gmail.com
Website	www.rknexora.org
Internship Topic	Agri-Business Management

1. Vision

To support students in developing practical, professional and industry-relevant capabilities.

2. Mission

To deliver structured learning experiences that connect academic knowledge with workplace expectations.

3. Activities of the Agency

1. Structured internship programmes aligned with university and higher-education requirements.
2. Skill-development learning modules, practical activities and assignments.
3. Attendance tracking, supervision, assessment and documentation.
4. Employability-oriented guidance connecting campus learning to career readiness.

4. Programme Structure

The internship programme is organised around a fixed number of learning hours, completed over a defined period. Each intern is registered on the internship portal with a unique registration number, is assigned a supervisor, follows a day-wise plan and maintains an attendance log. Learning is organised into three phases: **Orientation** (Days 1-2), **Learning and Practice** (Days 3-22, ten sub-topics of two days each: one concept day and one hands-on day) and **Project and Review** (Days 23-28), followed by a concluding review.

5. Role of the Supervisor

The internship supervisor assigned by the agency guided the student through the programme, explained concepts, assigned practice tasks, reviewed the daily log and gave feedback. The supervisor also verified attendance and reviewed the student's work at the end of the programme.

PLAN AND EXECUTION

1. Objectives

The internship was planned around the following objectives, each linked to a part of the programme:

1. Understand Agri-Business Management - the agri-business sector, value chain, stakeholders and scope (Week 1).
2. Learn farm management basics - farm planning, resources, crop calendar and record keeping (Week 1).
3. Learn the input supply chain and post-harvest management - seeds, fertilisers and pesticides, and handling, storage, grading, transport and loss reduction (Week 2).
4. Understand agri finance and credit, crop insurance, warehousing and storage - crop loans, KCC, insurance schemes, warehouse types, receipts and costs (Weeks 2-3).
5. Understand agri commodity markets and agricultural policy - exchanges, price discovery, MSP, policies and reforms (Weeks 3-4).
6. Learn cost-benefit analysis - comparing costs and benefits of a project and calculating returns (Week 4).
7. Develop professional discipline - communication, accuracy, honesty, documentation and report writing (throughout).

2. Methodology

The programme followed a blended method made up of four connected steps, repeated for each topic:

Learn. Each topic began with a concept session in which the supervisor explained the purpose of the function, its main records and how it connects with the other parts of the agri value chain. Notes were prepared in the student's own words.

Practise. The concepts were then applied in guided hands-on tasks - drawing the agri value chain, preparing a crop calendar and crop budget, estimating input requirements, calculating post-harvest losses, working out loan interest and insurance premium, comparing storage costs and benefits, studying a futures hedge, summarising a policy and calculating NPV and benefit-cost ratio in MS Excel. Only sample or dummy data were used, so that no real farmer, bank or company information was handled.

Document. Every day's work was recorded in the internship attendance log with a short remark, and sheets, charts and drafts were saved so that the work could be reviewed.

Review. The supervisor reviewed the work, pointed out errors and suggested improvements. Review days, a case study and a mock practical exercise helped to consolidate the learning.

3. Understanding Agri-Business Management - Concepts Studied

3.1 The agri-business sector and its value chain

Agri-business means all the businesses and activities that together bring food and farm products from the field to the consumer. The term was first used for the total of operations involved in the production and distribution of farm supplies, farm production, and the storage, processing and distribution of farm commodities. The sector includes input companies (seed, fertiliser, pesticide, machinery and irrigation equipment), farmers and farmer groups, traders and commission agents, warehouses and cold storages, processors and millers, retailers and exporters, and supporting institutions such as banks, insurance companies, research institutes and government departments. Agriculture still employs a large share of India's workforce and contributes a significant part of the economy, though its exact share changes from year to year and should be checked in the latest Economic Survey.

The agri value chain describes the stages through which a farm product passes and gains value: supply of inputs, production on the farm, harvesting, post-harvest handling, storage, processing, distribution, retail and

the consumer. Around the main chain run the supporting services of finance, insurance, extension and training, research, transport and information. Each stakeholder has its own interest: the farmer wants a good price and stable income, the input dealer wants regular sales, the trader wants a margin, the processor wants steady quality and supply, the bank wants repayment, and the consumer wants safe food at a fair price. Agri-business management tries to coordinate these interests so that the whole chain becomes efficient and the farmer gets a fair share. The scope of the subject covers farm management, supply chain and logistics, agricultural finance and insurance, marketing and commodity trading, policy analysis and agri-technology.

3.2 Farm management basics

Farm management is the science of organising and operating a farm to earn the best income from limited resources. The main resources are land, labour, capital (money, machines and stock), water and the management skill of the farmer. Basic principles help in decisions. The law of diminishing returns says that adding more of one input, such as fertiliser, to a fixed amount of land gives smaller and smaller extra output after some point. Opportunity cost means the value of the best alternative that is given up when a resource is used in one way. The farmer also chooses among enterprises that can be competitive (they compete for the same land and labour, such as paddy and maize in the same season), supplementary (they use otherwise idle resources, such as goat rearing with crops) or complementary (they help each other, such as pulses that improve soil for the next crop or dairy that gives manure).

Farm planning starts with a farm inventory (land, water source, soil type, buildings, machines, family labour and money) and a decision on what to grow. The decision considers the soil and climate, water availability, the market and expected price, the cost and profit, the risk and the farmer's skills. A crop calendar sets out the sowing, irrigation, fertiliser, plant protection and harvesting dates through the year. In India there are three main seasons: kharif (sown with the monsoon in June and July and harvested in October and November, for example paddy, maize and arhar), rabi (sown in October and November and harvested in March and April, for example wheat, gram, lentil, mustard and potato) and zaid (the summer season between March and June, for example vegetables, moong and watermelon). Bihar's main pattern is paddy in kharif and wheat in rabi, with maize, pulses, oilseeds, vegetables and fruits as important additions.

Records are the heart of farm management. A farmer should keep a cash book of income and expenses, an input register (what was bought, when, from whom and at what price), a crop-wise record of operations, a produce and sales register, and a loan and repayment record. These records make it possible to calculate the cost of cultivation and the net income of each crop. In farm cost studies, **Cost A2** covers all paid-out costs (seed, fertiliser, pesticide, hired labour, machine hire, irrigation, depreciation, interest on borrowed money and rent paid for leased land), **Cost A2+FL** adds the value of unpaid family labour, and **Cost C2** is the most comprehensive and also includes the rent value of owned land and interest on owned capital. Net income is gross income minus cost, and the benefit-cost ratio is gross income divided by cost. Tools such as the Soil Health Card help farmers to apply fertiliser according to their soil's needs and reduce wasteful spending.

3.3 Input supply chain

Farm inputs are the products and services a farmer needs before and during the crop: seeds, fertilisers, pesticides and herbicides, farm machinery and tools, irrigation equipment, feed for livestock and credit. The input supply chain normally runs from the manufacturer or producer to a wholesaler or distributor, then to a retail dealer, and then to the farmer. Cooperative societies such as PACS and cooperative fertiliser companies, agriculture department centres and state seed corporations are also important suppliers, and farmer groups can buy in bulk. In Bihar, certified seed is supplied through the state seed corporation, the Beej Gram programme and private dealers.

Input supply is governed by laws to protect farmers from poor quality. The Seeds Act, 1966 and its rules provide for certification and labelling of seed; the Fertiliser (Control) Order, 1985 regulates the quality, price and sale of fertilisers, and the Insecticides Act, 1968 regulates pesticides, which must be registered and sold only by licensed dealers. Fertilisers such as urea and DAP are sold at government-controlled subsidised prices,

and the subsidy is routed through point-of-sale machines at the dealer's shop so that the farmer's identity is verified at purchase. Good input management means estimating the need for each crop in advance (for example seed rate per acre multiplied by the area), buying at the right time, from a licensed dealer, checking the label, batch number, expiry date and price, keeping the bill, storing inputs safely and, wherever possible, buying together through an FPO or cooperative for a lower price. Common problems are shortage at peak season, black marketing, spurious or substandard products, delayed supply and lack of advice on correct use.

3.4 Post-harvest management

Post-harvest management covers everything done with produce after it is harvested and before it reaches the consumer: harvesting at the right stage, threshing, cleaning, drying, sorting and grading, packing, storage, transport and primary processing. Losses can occur at every step. Government institutes studying post-harvest losses in India estimate that losses are several per cent in cereals and pulses and considerably higher in fruits, vegetables and other perishables. Causes of loss include harvesting too early or too late, rough handling, spillage in threshing and transport, delay in drying, wet storage that causes mould and fungus, attack by rats, insects and birds, poor packaging, heat, long journeys and the lack of cold chain for perishable produce.

Losses are reduced by harvesting at the correct maturity and moisture, cleaning and drying grain to a safe moisture level before storage, using sound bags or bins and hermetic storage bags, protecting stock from pests and moisture, stacking on pallets or dunnage with gaps for air, using crates and ventilated packing for fruits and vegetables, pre-cooling and cold storage for perishables, careful loading and transport, and processing surplus into durable products. The quantity of loss at each step can be measured and valued in rupees; this shows the farmer or business where improvement will pay the most.

3.5 Agri finance and credit

Farmers need finance for short-term needs (seed, fertiliser, labour and other seasonal expenses), medium-term needs (equipment, a tubewell, livestock or plantation) and long-term needs (land development, irrigation, a godown or cold storage). Sources are institutional - commercial banks, regional rural banks, cooperative banks and PACS, with refinance from NABARD - and non-institutional, such as moneylenders, traders, commission agents and relatives. Non-institutional credit is easy to get but is often expensive, and loans from moneylenders at high monthly interest can trap small farmers in debt. Institutional credit is cheaper and supported by government interest benefits.

The **Kisan Credit Card (KCC)** is the main tool for short-term crop credit. It gives a farmer a revolving credit limit for cultivation expenses and, in many cases, working capital for allied activities such as dairy and fisheries. The amount of credit per acre for each crop is decided by a technical committee at the district or state level as the *scale of finance*. Under the Modified Interest Subvention Scheme, the Government gives interest benefit so that farmers who repay on time pay a much lower effective interest rate; the limits and rates of this benefit are revised from time to time and must be checked on current notifications. The usual documents for a KCC are the application form, identity and address proof, land records or lease papers, photographs and, where required, a declaration of crops. The loan is normally repaid after harvest, and timely repayment keeps the interest low and the credit record good. Other agricultural loans include term loans for machinery and irrigation, gold loans, loans under the Agriculture Infrastructure Fund, warehouse-receipt loans, and loans for self-help groups under the livelihoods mission. Interest on a loan is calculated on the principal for the period it is outstanding: simple interest = principal x rate x time.

3.6 Crop insurance

Farming faces risks from drought, flood, hail, cyclone, pests and diseases, which are beyond the farmer's control. Crop insurance shares this risk by paying compensation for losses in return for a small premium. India's main scheme, the **Pradhan Mantri Fasal Bima Yojana (PMFBY)**, started in 2016. Farmers pay a low fixed premium, which is 2% of the sum insured for kharif food crops and oilseeds, 1.5% for rabi food crops and oilseeds and 5% for annual commercial and horticultural crops, and the balance of the premium is shared by the Central and State Governments. The sum insured is generally linked to the scale of finance. Insurance covers

prevented sowing, loss of standing crop from natural calamities, pests and diseases, loss in the post-harvest period of a limited number of days for crops drying in the field, and localised calamities such as hailstorm, landslide and flood on an individual field basis.

For widespread losses, compensation is worked out by the *area approach*: the actual yield of the insurance unit (for example a village or group of villages), measured through crop cutting experiments and increasingly through remote sensing, is compared with the threshold yield, and if the actual yield is lower, a claim is paid in proportion to the shortfall. Farmers who have taken crop loans are normally covered through their bank, while others can enrol voluntarily through banks, common service centres or the national crop insurance portal before the cut-off date. In case of localised loss the farmer must report the loss within 72 hours through the Crop Insurance App, the toll-free helpline 14447, the bank, the insurance company or the agriculture department, after which the insurer assesses the loss and pays through direct benefit transfer. Bihar has run its own state crop assistance scheme, the Bihar Rajya Fasal Sahayata Yojana, in place of PMFBY, so the scheme in force in the state should always be checked.

3.7 Warehousing and storage

Warehousing allows produce to be kept safely until it is sold or processed, so that supply can be spread through the year and price falls at harvest can be avoided. Warehouses may be run by the Central Warehousing Corporation, State Warehousing Corporations, the Food Corporation of India, cooperatives or private companies. Types include general warehouses for grains and other dry goods, bonded warehouses for goods under customs control, cold storages for fruits, vegetables, potato and dairy, silos for bulk grain and farm-level structures such as bins and godowns. Cold storages are used widely for potato in Bihar.

Good storage conditions depend on low moisture, suitable temperature, ventilation, cleanliness, pest control and good stacking, with older stock issued first (FIFO or FEFO). Storage costs include rent or storage charges per quintal per month, handling and labour, insurance, fumigation and pest control, shrinkage and the interest on the money locked in the stock. Warehouses registered under the **Warehousing (Development and Regulation) Act, 2007** with the Warehousing Development and Regulatory Authority (WDRA) can issue **electronic negotiable warehouse receipts (e-NWR)**, which are proof of ownership of stored goods that can be traded or pledged. A farmer can take a loan against the receipt from a bank instead of selling in distress, and may also sell the stored produce on the e-NAM platform. A farmer benefits from storage only when the expected price rise is larger than the total cost of storage.

3.8 Agri commodity markets

Agricultural commodities are traded in the *spot market*, where goods are bought and sold for immediate delivery and payment (as in the mandi and the e-NAM), and in the *futures market*, where a contract is made today to buy or sell a fixed quantity and quality at a fixed price on a future date. Commodity derivatives in India are regulated by the Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI), and trading takes place on exchanges such as the National Commodity and Derivatives Exchange (NCDEX) for agricultural commodities and the Multi Commodity Exchange (MCX) mainly for metals and energy. Each contract specifies the commodity, quality, lot size, delivery centre, expiry date and margin. Delivery takes place through accredited warehouses. The futures price reflects what the market expects the price to be, so it helps in *price discovery* and gives farmers, traders and processors a signal for planning. Trading in futures of some agricultural commodities has been suspended by SEBI from time to time to control price rise, so the current position must always be checked.

Commodity markets are used for *hedging* and for *speculation*. A hedger, such as a trader who holds stock or a processor who must buy later, takes a position in the futures market opposite to the physical position to reduce the risk of price changes. A speculator takes a position to earn from price movements, accepting risk. The difference between the spot price and the futures price is called the basis. Farmers and FPOs benefit most from understanding futures prices as a market signal and, where possible, selling through the exchange-linked platforms or forward contracts; direct trading is complex and risky and needs training. Prices of commodities are also affected by world markets, exchange rates, weather, stocks and government policy.

3.9 Agricultural policy

Agricultural policy is the set of government decisions that affect farm production, prices, trade and farmers' incomes. The **Minimum Support Price (MSP)** is announced by the Government for 22 mandated crops, on the recommendation of the Commission for Agricultural Costs and Prices (CACP), which considers the cost of production, demand and supply, market price trends, the price relation between crops, the effect on consumers and other factors. Since the Budget of 2018-19 the Government has stated that MSP is fixed at a level of at least one and a half times the all-India weighted average cost of production (A2+FL). Government agencies such as the FCI and state agencies buy wheat and rice at MSP for the public distribution system under the National Food Security Act, 2013 and for buffer stocks; in Bihar, procurement of paddy and wheat is largely through PACS.

Other major policies and schemes include PM-KISAN income support, the Soil Health Card scheme, the Pradhan Mantri Krishi Sinchayee Yojana for irrigation ('more crop per drop'), PM-KUSUM for solar pumps, fertiliser subsidy, crop insurance, the scheme for formation of 10,000 FPOs, the Agriculture Infrastructure Fund, the National Agriculture Market (e-NAM), organic farming missions, export and import policies, and stock limits under the Essential Commodities Act. Bihar prepares an Agriculture Road Map for the state at five-year intervals with targets for crops, horticulture, dairy and fisheries. Studying a policy means asking: what is the objective, who are the beneficiaries, what instruments are used, what is the cost to the budget, what have been the effects and what problems exist. For example, MSP and procurement have given income security and encouraged production of wheat and rice, but they have also been criticised for leaving out many farmers and crops and for promoting water-intensive cropping in some regions. Reforms such as the farm laws passed in 2020 and repealed in 2021 show that changes in agricultural markets need wide consultation with farmers and states.

3.10 Cost-benefit analysis

Cost-benefit analysis (CBA) is a method of deciding whether a project or investment is worth doing by comparing all its costs with all its benefits, expressed in money. Costs include the initial investment and the yearly running costs; benefits include extra income, savings in losses and other gains. Benefits and costs come in different years, and a rupee received today is worth more than a rupee received later, so future amounts are converted into present value by *discounting* at a rate that reflects the cost of money. The **present value** of an amount received in year t is that amount divided by (1 + r) raised to the power t. The **Net Present Value (NPV)** is the present value of benefits minus the present value of costs, and a project with a positive NPV is worth doing. The **Benefit-Cost Ratio (BCR)** is the present value of benefits divided by the present value of costs; a ratio above 1 is acceptable. Other measures are the payback period and the Internal Rate of Return (IRR). Where the benefit is the same every year, the present value of the yearly amount for n years is the amount multiplied by the annuity factor [1 - (1 + r)^-n] / r.

CBA also asks about non-money effects, such as reduced drudgery, better health or environmental benefit, and tests the result with a sensitivity analysis: what happens to NPV if benefits fall by twenty per cent or costs rise by ten per cent. In agriculture, CBA is used to judge investments such as a godown, cold storage, drip irrigation, a farm machine, a processing unit or a farmer group's input shop, and also to evaluate government schemes.

3.11 Ethics, rules and limitations

Agri-business involves the livelihood of farmers and the safety of food, so honesty is essential: true weights and grades, genuine inputs, fair prices, prompt payments and correct advice. Schemes, rates, interest benefits, premium rates, exchange rules and policies change often, so every figure in this report is for learning only and must be verified from current official sources before use. An intern works only with sample data and does not handle real farmer, bank or customer information.

4. Week-wise Plan and Execution

Week	Days	Activities
Week 1	Days 1-6	Orientation and foundations: company induction, introduction to agri-business management, agri-business overview, and farm management basics.
Week 2	Days 7-12	Inputs, produce and money: input supply chain, post-harvest management, and agri finance and credit, each with a concept session and a hands-on task.
Week 3	Days 13-18	Protection, storage and markets: crop insurance, warehousing and storage, and agri commodity markets.
Week 4	Days 19-24	Policy and analysis: agri policy study, cost-benefit analysis, a case study exercise and a mock practical exercise.
Week 5	Days 25-28	Project closure: supervisor review and feedback, internship report drafting, presentation preparation and final review.

5. Week-wise Narrative

Week 1: The first week was devoted to orientation and foundations. After company induction, the student was introduced to agri-business management and studied the agri-business sector, value chain, stakeholders and scope. The week ended with a study of farm management basics - farm planning, resources, crop calendar and record keeping - supported by preparation of a crop calendar and a sample farm record.

Week 2: In the second week the study moved to the input supply chain - seeds, fertilisers, pesticides, suppliers and distribution - followed by post-harvest management, covering handling, storage, grading, transport and loss reduction, and agri finance and credit, covering crop loans, the Kisan Credit Card, interest and repayment.

Week 3: The third week focused on crop insurance - insurance schemes, premium, coverage and the claim process; warehousing and storage - warehouse types, storage conditions, receipts and costs; and agri commodity markets - commodity exchanges, price discovery and trading basics.

Week 4: In the fourth week the student studied agri policy - MSP, agricultural policies, reforms and their effects - and cost-benefit analysis, comparing the costs and benefits of a project and calculating returns. A case study exercise and a mock practical exercise were completed in this week.

Week 5: The last week was devoted to project closure: supervisor review and feedback, drafting of the internship report, preparation of a presentation and final review before submission.

6. Topic-wise Learning in Detail

6.1 Agri-Business Overview and Farm Management Basics

Concept: The agri-business sector, value chain, stakeholders and scope; farm planning, resources, crop calendar and record keeping. *Practice carried out:* Drawing the agri value chain with stakeholders and their roles; preparing a crop calendar for a paddy-wheat farm and a sample farm record sheet.

6.2 Input Supply Chain

Concept: Seeds, fertilisers, pesticides, suppliers and distribution of inputs, with the laws that protect farmers. *Practice carried out:* Estimating the input requirement for a sample farm, preparing a purchase plan and an input purchase checklist, and comparing individual and group purchase.

6.3 Post-Harvest Management

Concept: Handling, storage, grading, transport and loss reduction. *Practice carried out:* Listing the loss points from harvest to market for a sample crop, valuing the loss and suggesting measures to reduce it.

6.4 Agri Finance and Credit

Concept: Crop loans, Kisan Credit Card, interest and repayment. *Practice carried out:* Preparing a KCC document checklist, calculating interest with and without interest benefit and preparing a loan repayment schedule.

6.5 Crop Insurance

Concept: Insurance schemes, premium, coverage and the claim process. *Practice carried out:* Calculating the farmer's premium and a claim for a sample area-yield loss and drawing the claim process flow.

6.6 Warehousing and Storage

Concept: Warehouse types, storage conditions, receipts and costs. *Practice carried out:* Preparing a storage cost-benefit sheet, a warehouse checklist and a flow of a warehouse receipt loan.

6.7 Agri Commodity Markets

Concept: Commodity exchanges, price discovery and trading basics. *Practice carried out:* Reading a sample futures price table, working out a simple hedge on dummy data and explaining basis and margin.

6.8 Agri Policy Study and Cost-Benefit Analysis

Concept: MSP, agricultural policies, reforms and their effects; comparing the costs and benefits of a project and calculating returns. *Practice carried out:* Preparing a two-page study of MSP with its objective, beneficiaries, effects and issues; calculating NPV and benefit-cost ratio of a sample godown project in MS Excel.

7. Important Laws, Schemes and Good Practice - Points Studied

Several laws and schemes govern the sector. The **Seeds Act, 1966**, the **Fertiliser (Control) Order, 1985** and the **Insecticides Act, 1968** protect the quality of inputs. The **Warehousing (Development and Regulation) Act, 2007** regulates warehouses and e-NWR. The **Essential Commodities Act, 1955** allows controls on stock and movement of certain items. **SEBI** regulates commodity derivatives. The **National Food Security Act, 2013** underlies public procurement and distribution of foodgrains. **MSP**, **PM-KISAN**, **KCC with interest subvention**, **PMFBY**, the **Agriculture Infrastructure Fund** and **e-NAM** are key schemes and platforms. The **Consumer Protection Act, 2019** and the **Legal Metrology Act, 2009** protect buyers and ensure correct weights.

Good practice includes keeping farm records, buying only from licensed dealers and keeping bills, testing the soil before applying fertiliser, using institutional credit and repaying on time, insuring the crop, drying and storing produce carefully, comparing prices before selling, and doing a cost-benefit check before every large investment. Farmers should be careful about offers of quick money, unlicensed lenders and unverified agents.

8. Process Flows Studied

Process mapping was used to understand how inputs, produce, money and information move through the agri-business system and who is responsible at each step. The main flows studied were:

- **Agri value chain:** Inputs > Production > Harvest > Post-harvest handling > Storage > Processing > Distribution > Retail > Consumer, with finance, insurance and policy support at each stage.
- **Input purchase:** Estimate requirement > Choose licensed dealer or cooperative > Check label, batch, expiry and price > Pay and keep bill > Store safely > Record in input register.
- **KCC loan:** Application with documents > Bank verification and scale of finance > Sanction of limit > Withdrawal for inputs > Harvest and sale > Repayment in time > Interest benefit and renewal.
- **Crop insurance claim:** Enrolment and premium > Loss event > Report within 72 hours > Assessment by insurer or yield data > Claim calculation > Payment by DBT.

- **Warehouse receipt finance:** Produce tested and deposited > e-NWR issued > Pledge to bank > Loan given > Sale at a better price > Loan repaid and receipt released.
- **Cost-benefit analysis:** Define project > List costs and benefits by year > Choose discount rate > Calculate NPV and BCR > Test sensitivity > Decide.

9. Worked Examples with Sample (Dummy) Data

Example A: Crop budget of wheat per acre (dummy figures)

Paid-out costs per acre: seed Rs. 1,800; fertiliser Rs. 3,500; pesticide Rs. 800; irrigation Rs. 1,500; hired labour Rs. 3,000; machine hire Rs. 3,200; other expenses Rs. 700. Cost A2 = Rs. 14,500. Adding family labour of Rs. 3,000 gives Cost A2+FL = Rs. 17,500, and adding the rent value of owned land (Rs. 6,000) and interest on owned capital (Rs. 500) gives Cost C2 = Rs. 24,000. With a yield of 16 quintals per acre at Rs. 2,300 per quintal, gross income = 16 x 2,300 = Rs. 36,800. Net income over A2 is Rs. 22,300 and over C2 is Rs. 12,800. Benefit-cost ratio on C2 = 36,800 / 24,000 = about 1.53. The budget shows that a farmer who counts only cash costs thinks the profit is high, while the full cost shows a more modest return, which is why records and C2 matter.

Example B: Input requirement and group purchase (dummy figures)

A sample group of five farmers cultivates 10 acres of wheat. At a dummy seed rate of 40 kg per acre the group needs 400 kg of certified seed. Fertiliser need at dummy doses is 50 kg of urea and 25 kg of DAP per acre, so 500 kg of urea and 250 kg of DAP in total. If the group buys through the PACS or a licensed dealer in bulk and gets a saving of 3% on a total input bill of Rs. 1,45,000, the saving is Rs. 4,350 or about Rs. 435 per acre, besides avoiding the risk of shortage by pre-booking. The group also checks labels and batch numbers, keeps the bills and divides the cost by area in a simple sheet.

Example C: Post-harvest loss (dummy figures)

A sample farmer harvests 100 quintals of potatoes. Losses are 2 quintals in digging and handling, 3 quintals in sorting (damaged tubers), 2 quintals in transport and 1 quintal in the market, a total of 8 quintals or 8%. At a value of Rs. 1,500 per quintal the loss is Rs. 12,000. If padded crates, careful loading and shaded sorting reduce the loss to 4%, the saving is 4 quintals, worth Rs. 6,000, at a cost of Rs. 1,500 for crates and handling, a net gain of Rs. 4,500. The example shows that loss reduction is often the cheapest way of increasing income.

Example D: KCC interest (dummy figures)

A farmer draws Rs. 1,00,000 under a KCC for 9 months for paddy cultivation. At an assumed interest rate of 7% a year, simple interest = 1,00,000 x 7 / 100 x 9 / 12 = Rs. 5,250. If the farmer repays on time and receives an assumed interest benefit of 3% a year, the effective rate is 4% and the interest comes to 1,00,000 x 4 / 100 x 9 / 12 = Rs. 3,000, a saving of Rs. 2,250. If the same amount was borrowed from a moneylender at 3% per month for 9 months, the interest would be 1,00,000 x 3 / 100 x 9 = Rs. 27,000, or nine times the KCC interest. The rates are assumed for the exercise and the current scheme rates must be checked.

Example E: Crop insurance premium and claim (dummy figures)

A farmer insures 2 hectares of kharif paddy. The sum insured is Rs. 40,000 per hectare and the farmer's premium is assumed at 2%, so the premium = 40,000 x 2% = Rs. 800 per hectare, or Rs. 1,600 in all. The threshold yield of the insurance unit is 30 quintals per hectare. Because of a drought, the actual yield of the unit is found by crop cutting experiments to be 21 quintals per hectare. Shortfall = (30 - 21) / 30 = 30%. Claim = 30% x 40,000 = Rs. 12,000 per hectare, or Rs. 24,000 for 2 hectares. The farmer paid Rs. 1,600 and receives Rs. 24,000, which helps to repay the crop loan.

Example F: Storage cost-benefit (dummy figures)

A farmer can store 100 quintals of wheat for 3 months. The price at harvest is Rs. 2,200 per quintal and is expected to be Rs. 2,450 after three months, a rise of Rs. 250 per quintal, or Rs. 25,000 in total. Costs: storage charge Rs. 5 per quintal per month x 3 x 100 = Rs. 1,500; insurance Rs. 200; shrinkage 0.5% = 0.5 quintal worth

Rs. 1,225; and interest at 8% a year on Rs. 2,20,000 for 3 months = Rs. 4,400. Total cost = Rs. 7,325. Net gain = 25,000 - 7,325 = Rs. 17,675. Storage pays only if the expected price rise is larger than Rs. 73 per quintal, which is the cost per quintal. If the farmer needs money, a warehouse receipt loan can provide cash without selling.

Example G: A simple hedge in the futures market (dummy figures)

A trader holds 100 quintals of maize bought at Rs. 2,000 per quintal and fears a price fall. The trader sells a futures contract for 100 quintals at Rs. 2,100. After a month the spot price falls to Rs. 1,900 and the futures price to Rs. 2,000. The loss on the physical stock is 100 x (2,000 - 1,900) = Rs. 10,000 (against the purchase price), while the gain on the futures position is 100 x (2,100 - 2,000) = Rs. 10,000. The two cancel out, so the trader is protected from the price fall; if the price had risen, the gain on stock would have been cancelled by the loss on futures. Margin money must be deposited for the futures position, and the hedge works well only when spot and futures prices move together.

Example H: Cost-benefit analysis of a farmer group's godown (dummy figures)

A sample FPO plans a godown that costs Rs. 10,00,000 and lasts 10 years. Yearly benefits (storage service income and reduced losses) are expected to be Rs. 3,00,000, and yearly running costs (staff, repair, insurance) Rs. 80,000. At a discount rate of 10%, the annuity factor for 10 years is 6.1446. Present value of benefits = 3,00,000 x 6.1446 = Rs. 18,43,370. Present value of running costs = 80,000 x 6.1446 = Rs. 4,91,565. Total present value of costs = 10,00,000 + 4,91,565 = Rs. 14,91,565. NPV = 18,43,370 - 14,91,565 = about Rs. 3,51,800, which is positive. Benefit-cost ratio = 18,43,370 / 14,91,565 = about 1.24. The simple payback period is 10,00,000 / (3,00,000 - 80,000) = about 4.5 years.

In a sensitivity test, if benefits fall by 20% (to Rs. 2,40,000 a year), the present value of benefits becomes Rs. 14,74,696 and the NPV becomes about minus Rs. 16,900, with a BCR of 0.99. The project is therefore profitable under the expected conditions but has little margin for error, so the group should secure storage commitments from members and local traders before investing.

10. Project: Agri-Business Supply Chain & Cost Analysis

Scope. The internship work was organised around a project in which the agri value chain, post-harvest handling and finance options were analysed with a cost-benefit study, using sample data and templates. A paddy-wheat farm and a farmer group's godown were taken as the sample cases.

Steps followed. (i) Drew the value chain of a sample crop and listed stakeholders; (ii) prepared a crop calendar and crop budget with Cost A2 and C2; (iii) estimated inputs and compared individual and group purchase; (iv) listed post-harvest losses and measures to reduce them; (v) calculated KCC interest, insurance premium and claim and a storage cost-benefit; (vi) carried out an NPV and benefit-cost analysis of a godown with a sensitivity test, wrote the summary and reviewed the work with the supervisor.

Skills and tools. Farm Management, Agri Supply Chain, Agri Finance, Warehousing, Commodity Markets and MS Excel.

Outputs. Value chain map, crop calendar and budget, input plan, post-harvest loss sheet, finance and insurance calculations, storage and hedge examples, cost-benefit workbook, policy note on MSP, and this internship report.

11. Case Study Exercise: Input Shortage, Costly Credit and Crop Loss in a Village

A case study exercise was completed on a typical agri-business problem. The village and figures are illustrative and not taken from any real place.

Background. In a sample village of about 60 farming families, most farmers grow paddy in kharif and wheat in rabi on small holdings. Few of them keep records, and only a few have Kisan Credit Cards.

Problem observed. At the time of top-dressing of wheat, urea became scarce at the local dealer and farmers bought it at a price higher than the fixed rate from an unlicensed seller, and some of them bought pesticide of doubtful quality that did not control the pest. Several farmers who had no institutional credit borrowed from a local moneylender at about 3% per month for the season. In March, hailstorm damaged the standing wheat in part of the village. Hardly anyone had insurance, and no one reported the loss in time. The farmers who had borrowed at high interest had to sell their produce immediately after harvest at a low price to repay.

Analysis. The root causes were weak planning, lack of records, dependence on a single input dealer, no access to cheap credit, no insurance and no storage. Inputs were bought late, at the peak of demand, without bills. Moneylender interest ate up a large part of the profit, and an uninsured natural calamity turned a bad season into a debt problem. There was no farmer group that could negotiate, buy together or share information.

Recommendations. (1) Prepare a crop calendar and estimate input needs in advance, and pre-book seed, fertiliser and pesticide through the PACS or a farmers' group. (2) Buy only from licensed dealers and demand bills; report overcharging to the agriculture department. (3) Help eligible farmers to obtain a Kisan Credit Card, with the right documents, so that they do not depend on moneylenders. (4) Enrol the crops in the crop insurance or state crop assistance scheme that applies, note the cut-off dates and teach farmers to report losses within 72 hours. (5) Use the Soil Health Card to apply fertiliser correctly. (6) Form a farmer group or FPO that can buy inputs together, use a common godown and take warehouse receipt loans so that farmers need not sell at once. (7) Keep simple farm records of costs and income.

Expected result and lesson learned. These steps are expected to reduce input cost, lower the interest burden, protect farmers from calamities and raise their net income. The lesson is that farm management is not only about growing a crop but about managing inputs, finance, risk and storage as one system.

12. Mock Practical Exercise: Managing the Business of One Season

In the mock practical exercise the student planned the business of one wheat season for a sample (dummy) 5-acre farm, from crop planning to cost-benefit review, using the formats and sheets practised earlier. The steps followed were:

1. **Farm plan:** prepared a farm inventory, crop plan and crop calendar for the season.
2. **Input plan:** estimated the requirement of seed, fertiliser and pesticide, compared sources and prepared a purchase schedule.
3. **Finance:** calculated the credit need from the scale of finance, prepared the KCC document checklist and calculated interest.
4. **Insurance:** calculated the premium and an example claim and noted the cut-off dates and loss reporting steps.
5. **Crop budget:** prepared the cost of cultivation (A2 and C2) and expected income.
6. **Post-harvest and storage:** planned drying, grading, packing and storage and prepared the storage cost-benefit.
7. **Market and policy:** compared mandi price and MSP and decided when and where to sell; noted the relevant schemes.
8. **Cost-benefit review:** calculated net income and benefit-cost ratio, tested the effect of a price fall and wrote a short management note.

The exercise showed that every step depends on the one before it: late inputs lower the yield, low yield with high interest means loss, and without insurance and storage a farmer has no protection against shocks.

13. Sample Checklists Prepared

Checklists were prepared as part of the hands-on tasks. They reduce errors and make routine work easier to review.

Farm Planning and Record Keeping Checklist

- Farm inventory of land, water, labour, machines and money prepared.
- Soil tested and Soil Health Card recommendations noted.
- Crop chosen on the basis of soil, water, market, cost and risk.
- Crop calendar with sowing, irrigation, fertiliser, protection and harvest dates.
- Cash book, input register, produce register and loan record maintained.
- Cost of cultivation (A2, C2) and net income calculated after harvest.
- Lessons noted for the next season.

Input Purchase Checklist

- Requirement estimated from area and recommended rates.
- Dealer holds a valid licence; price is as per the fixed or printed rate.
- Label, batch number, manufacturing and expiry dates checked.
- Seed is certified and the tag and germination details are available.
- Pesticide is registered and is used as per label instructions.
- Bill taken with name, date, quantity and price.
- Inputs stored dry, labelled and away from children and food.

Post-Harvest and Storage Checklist

- Crop harvested at proper maturity and cleaned.
- Grain dried to a safe moisture level before storage.
- Produce graded and packed in clean, sound bags, bins or crates.
- Storage place dry, ventilated, clean and pest-free.
- Bags stacked on pallets or dunnage, with gaps from walls.
- Regular inspection for moisture, insects and rodents.
- Storage cost and expected price rise compared before deciding to store.

Loan and Insurance Checklist

- Identity, address and land records ready for KCC application.
- Scale of finance and credit limit understood.
- Repayment date planned for after harvest to get the interest benefit.
- Crop enrolled in the applicable insurance scheme before the cut-off date.
- Premium receipt and policy details kept safely.
- Helpline and app details noted for reporting losses within 72 hours.
- Photographs and evidence of loss taken when a calamity occurs.

Cost-Benefit Analysis Checklist

- Project and its life defined clearly.

- All investment costs and yearly running costs listed.
- All yearly benefits, including savings in loss, listed.
- Discount rate chosen and explained.
- NPV, BCR and payback calculated.
- Sensitivity checked for fall in benefits and rise in costs.
- Non-money effects noted and decision recorded.

14. Tools and Resources

Learning materials, sample farm records and budgets, official scheme information from government portals (including KCC, PMFBY, e-NAM and WDRA), sample commodity price tables, MS Excel for crop budgets, interest, premium, storage and cost-benefit calculations, MS Word and PowerPoint for documentation and presentation, assignments and mentor feedback were used during the internship.

15. Programme at a Glance

The programme was in the domain of Agri-Business Management with RKNEXORA PRIVATE LIMITED as the agency. It required a minimum of 120 hours over 28 learning days, organised in three phases: Orientation (Days 1-2), Learning and Practice (Days 3-22) and Project and Review (Days 23-28). Attendance was recorded in the Internship Attendance Log, signed by the supervisor (see Attendance Sheet).

LEARNING OUTCOME

a. Knowledge Acquired

1. The structure of the agri-business sector, its value chain, stakeholders and scope.
2. Farm management basics: resources, enterprise choice, crop calendar, record keeping and cost concepts A2, A2+FL and C2.
3. The input supply chain for seeds, fertilisers and pesticides, the laws that protect quality and good purchase practice.
4. Post-harvest management, causes of loss and measures to reduce loss, and warehousing and storage including e-NWR.
5. Agri finance and credit, including the Kisan Credit Card, interest calculation and interest benefit, and the working of crop insurance.
6. Agri commodity markets, including spot and futures, hedging and price discovery, and the basics of agricultural policy such as MSP.
7. Cost-benefit analysis with discounting, NPV, benefit-cost ratio, payback and sensitivity testing.

Glossary of Terms Learned

- **Agri-business** - All businesses linked with farm inputs, production, storage, processing and marketing of agricultural products.
- **Value chain** - Series of stages through which a product gains value from input to consumer.
- **Kharif / Rabi / Zaid** - Monsoon, winter and summer cropping seasons.
- **Crop calendar** - Schedule of operations of a crop through the season.
- **Cost A2 / A2+FL / C2** - Paid-out cost / plus family labour / comprehensive cost with rent and interest on owned resources.
- **Soil Health Card** - Card giving the soil nutrient status and fertiliser advice to a farmer.
- **Post-harvest loss** - Loss of quantity or quality of produce after harvest.
- **KCC** - Kisan Credit Card for credit to farmers.
- **Scale of finance** - Per-acre credit amount fixed for each crop by a technical committee.
- **Interest subvention** - Government support that reduces the effective interest rate for farmers.
- **PMFBY** - Pradhan Mantri Fasal Bima Yojana, the crop insurance scheme.
- **Threshold yield** - Benchmark yield used to decide whether an insurance claim is payable.
- **WDRA / e-NWR** - Warehousing regulator / electronic negotiable warehouse receipt.
- **Spot market / Futures market** - Immediate-delivery market / market for contracts to be settled later.
- **Hedging** - Taking an opposite position in futures to reduce price risk.
- **Basis** - Difference between spot and futures price.
- **MSP** - Minimum Support Price announced by the Government for 22 mandated crops.
- **CACP** - Commission for Agricultural Costs and Prices that recommends MSP.
- **NPV / BCR** - Net present value / benefit-cost ratio used in cost-benefit analysis.
- **Discounting** - Converting future amounts into present value.

b. Skills Learned

Technical skills. Preparing crop calendars, farm records and crop budgets; estimating input requirements; calculating post-harvest loss and its value; computing loan interest, insurance premium and claim; comparing

storage costs and benefits; understanding a futures hedge; summarising an agricultural policy; and calculating NPV, benefit-cost ratio and payback in MS Excel.

Professional skills. Analytical and numerical thinking; planning and problem solving; clear explanation of technical matters to farmers and managers; honesty and responsibility with money and records; time management and teamwork; and documentation, report writing and presentation.

These skills were developed through repeated practice and daily documentation. Building crop budgets and cost-benefit sheets improved accuracy, studying policy improved critical thinking, and writing remarks and reports improved communication.

c. Observed Attitude and Gained Values

1. Respect for the farmer: understanding the risks and costs that farmers bear builds respect and responsibility.
2. Honesty and fairness in dealings: fair weights, genuine inputs, true records and prompt payments.
3. Evidence-based decisions: investments and policies must be judged with numbers and not with assumptions.
4. Discipline and punctuality: regular reporting at fixed timings and daily attendance records.
5. Prudence with risk and debt: insurance, savings and careful borrowing protect the farm business.

d. Challenges Faced

Understanding terms such as scale of finance, e-NWR, threshold yield, basis and NPV was handled by using a glossary, reference material and mentor guidance.

Understanding discounting and NPV was difficult at first; this was handled by working through the annuity factor example step by step and checking the Excel formulas with the supervisor.

Finding reliable scheme and rate information was handled by using only official government and regulator sources, and by marking all rates in the examples as assumed.

Working without real farm data was handled by using dummy figures with clear assumptions written beside each calculation.

Maintaining consistent documentation was handled by using daily log entries and reviewing feedback to improve documentation progressively.

Managing time between practice, documentation and report writing was handled by dividing work week by week and using review days for corrections.

e. Career Pathways

The knowledge gained supports careers such as Farm Manager or Agri-Business Executive, Sales and Technical Executive in seed, fertiliser, pesticide and equipment companies, Agri Credit Officer in banks and rural financial institutions, Crop Insurance Executive, Warehouse or Supply Chain Executive, Commodity Research Analyst, FPO Manager, Agri Policy Research Assistant and Project Executive in agri development programmes. Opportunities exist in agri-input and food companies, banks and insurers, warehousing and logistics firms, commodity exchanges and brokers, FPOs, research institutes and government programmes. Related higher-study options include MBA in Agri-Business Management or Rural Management at institutes such as MANAGE, NIAM and several agricultural universities and management institutes, and Master's programmes in Agricultural Economics.

CONCLUSION

The internship in Agri-Business Management was a valuable learning experience that integrated academic knowledge with practical activity. The programme achieved its objectives through structured learning, guided practice, assignments, supervisor review and documentation.

The student gained a clear understanding of how the agri-business system works - through the agri value chain, farm management, the input supply chain, post-harvest management, agri finance and credit, crop insurance, warehousing and storage, commodity markets, agricultural policy and cost-benefit analysis - and acquired practical familiarity with crop budgets, interest and premium calculations, storage and hedging examples and NPV analysis. The experience has strengthened the student's employability and provides a foundation for further study and work in agri-business, rural finance and food supply chains.

Reflection

Looking back, the most useful lesson of the internship was that agriculture should be managed as a business without forgetting that it is also a way of life. Knowing the true cost of cultivation, buying inputs on time, using cheap institutional credit, insuring against risk, storing and selling at the right time and checking every investment with a cost-benefit analysis can change a farm family's income. Moving from concept to practice to documentation made abstract ideas concrete, and supervisor feedback showed where understanding was weak. The habit of recording each day's work also made it easier to see progress over the weeks.

Objectives and Achievement

The objective of understanding the agri-business sector was achieved through concept sessions and a value chain map. The objective of learning farm management and the input supply chain was achieved through a crop calendar, crop budget and input plan. The objective of understanding post-harvest management, warehousing, finance and insurance was achieved through loss, interest, premium and storage calculations. The objective of understanding commodity markets and policy was achieved through a hedging example and a policy note on MSP. The objective of learning cost-benefit analysis was achieved by calculating NPV and benefit-cost ratio with a sensitivity test. The objective of developing professional discipline was achieved through daily attendance, supervisor review and report writing.

Future Scope

The knowledge gained can support further study of agri-business management, agricultural economics and rural finance, and careers in agri-input companies, banks, insurers, warehousing and logistics, commodity markets, FPOs and development agencies. With growing investment in agri infrastructure, digital platforms, institutional credit and insurance, trained agri-business managers are increasingly needed, including in Bihar.

Suggestions for Improvement of the Programme

1. Include visits to a warehouse, a cooperative society or a bank's agricultural branch, and talks by farmers and agri-business managers, with appropriate permissions.
2. Continue regular mentor feedback and progress reviews.
3. Provide more project-based activities such as preparing a full farm business plan for a local farmer.
4. Encourage students to maintain detailed daily documentation.

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ATTENDANCE SHEET

The Internship Attendance Log issued by the IPO, with the supervisor's signature for each day, is to be attached on this page.

[Attach the signed Internship Attendance Log here]